raising a clamorous hue, begin to move forward until they were about 75 yards from the enemy line, at which point they would break into a fast trot, throw their pila (javelins) and then smash into the enemy, using their swords for the deadly in-fighting. The Roman sword (gladius)—sometimes known as the "Spanish Sword"—was a particularly effective weapon capable of causing grievous wounds. The Greeks thought it was unfair. Ironically, the unit's name comes from the word for spear, hasta, which they no longer used.